

Question 38 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Mention any two features of an effective HRD practice.

Introduction

A feature is a quality you would look for if asked, 'Is this appraisal / training / career scheme effective as HRD?' Effective means it actually helps the development process rather than hindering it with fear or paperwork. Name two features in depth, then list others.

Detailed points

- 1. First feature — developmental purpose in real operation.** The practice exists to help people learn and grow, not only to control, rank, or complete a legal file. You can see this in what happens at the end: an individual development plan, coaching, a chance to practise. Example: an appraisal discussion that spends time on 'what will you try next quarter' is developmental. A five-minute form-signing for increment is not, even if the form heading says HRD.
- 2. How to test this feature.** Ask employees whether anything in their work changed after the practice. If never, the purpose is not developmental in reality. T.V. Rao's test: does the mechanism promote or hinder the HRD process?
- 3. Second feature — integration with other subsystems and with strategy.** An effective practice is joined to the rest of HRD and to organisational goals. Training comes from appraisal gaps and career plans and strategy, not from a vendor's catalogue. Career talks use potential data. Feedback is not a separate annual picnic. Isolation is a feature of ineffective practice.
- 4. Example of integration as a visible feature.** After a quality-training programme, the next appraisal includes a quality behaviour, the boss coaches weekly, and a project uses the new method. That training practice is effective because it is linked.
- 5. Other features to mention.** Need-based (diagnosis, TNA). Line-manager involvement. Fairness and transparency. Top-management support and resources. Consistency with HRD climate (does not terrify). Evaluated and improved. Culture-sensitive design.
- 6. Fairness as a strong extra feature.** Equity of access — not only favourites developed — is both an HRD objective and a feature of effectiveness, because unfair practices destroy climate and then nothing transfers.
- 7. Evaluation as a feature.** Effective practices have a review: climate survey, Kirkpatrick levels, HRD audit. Practices that never look at impact rot.
- 8. Exam shape.** Two features as full explanations with 'how you would recognise them', then a cluster of other features. Do not write two adjectives ('good', 'useful') without meaning.

Conclusion. Two key features of an effective HRD practice are a genuine developmental purpose (growth actions follow) and integration with other HRD subsystems and organisational strategy. Add diagnosis, line ownership, fairness, support, climate fit and evaluation. Features are what you can observe, not what the brochure claims.